Trip Report

DFRWS APAC 2026

October 19–22, 2026, Singapore

1. Overview





My research paper was accepted to DFRWS APAC 2026, and I attended the conference to present it. DFRWS is an international conference that focuses on research in digital forensics. Since my research was on digital forensics, I was looking forward to meeting researchers in this area and introducing my own work to them. This conference had a special meaning for me, because it was my first international conference and I was going to present my paper.

The paper I presented was titled “CARVE: Recovering and Reconstructing Deleted H.264/H.265 Video from Honeywell Surveillance Systems”. Presenting this work at an international conference was both exciting and a little stressful, but I saw it as an important chance to receive feedback from experts in the field.

The conference lasted four days. The first two days were for hands-on workshops, and the last two days were for the keynote, research paper sessions, posters, and social events.

2. Conference

Day 1 – Workshop: Agentic AI for Digital Forensics





On the first day, I attended the workshop “Agentic AI for Digital Forensics and Investigation: Safely Building Interoperable Investigation Tools,” which was held in two parts. The workshop explained how AI agents can be used to support forensic analysis and investigation work. It focused on how to connect AI agents with forensic tools in a way that is safe, controlled, and works well across different tools.

Part 1 introduced the basic ideas of agentic AI and the possible uses of AI agents in digital forensics. Part 2 was more practical and showed how such tools can be built step by step. An important message of the workshop was that, in forensics, results must be reliable and explainable. Because of this, AI tools need clear limits, careful checking of their outputs, and records of what they did. This workshop helped me think about how AI could be used in my own research in a responsible way.

Day 2 – Workshops: GPS in Digital Forensics and Warrant Returns

On the second day, I attended two workshops, each with two parts. The first was “Understanding the Methods and Limits of GPS in Digital Forensics.” This workshop explained how location data from GPS is created and stored on devices, and how it can be used as evidence. It also showed that GPS data has limits in accuracy and reliability. I learned that investigators should understand these limits well before using location data to draw conclusions in a case.

The second workshop was “Normalizing and Enriching Warrant Returns with Cyber Domain Ontologies.” Data received from service providers through warrants often comes in many different formats, which makes it hard to analyze and compare. This workshop showed how such data can be converted into a common, structured format using cyber domain ontologies, and how it can be enriched with additional information. I found this useful because it showed how standard data formats can make forensic analysis faster, more consistent, and easier to share between tools and teams.

Day 3 – Keynote, Paper Sessions, Banquet, and Rodeo

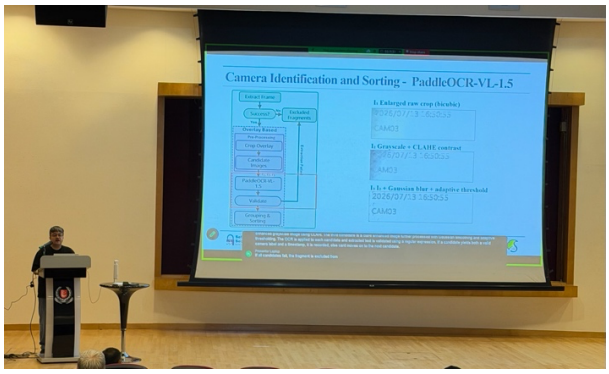
The main conference began on the third day with a keynote speech, followed by the research paper sessions. I listened to many paper presentations on different topics in digital forensics. It was interesting to see how researchers from different countries and organizations approach forensic problems, and how many different devices and types of data are being studied.

In the evening, there was a banquet, followed by the Rodeo, a digital forensics Capture the Flag (CTF) competition. During the Rodeo, participants worked in teams to solve forensic challenges within a limited time. It was a fun and practical experience that allowed me to use my knowledge in a real problem-solving situation. It was also a good chance to talk with other participants in a relaxed setting.

Day 4 – Paper Presentation and Closing

The fourth day was the most important day for me, because I presented my paper. I had prepared by revising my slides and script several times and by thinking about questions the audience might ask. Even so, I felt nervous before the presentation, especially because I was presenting my paper in front of professionals who already have decades of experience in this field.

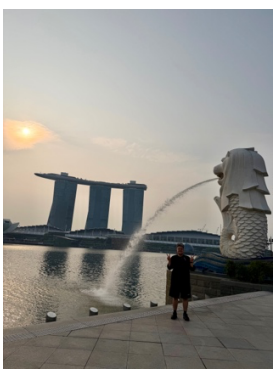




After the presentation, I received question from Dr. Matthew Sorell. After answering his question, we had a short discussion regarding my work where he mentioned that my approach was rather complicated and could have been solved using a simpler approach which was to compare the background of the video fragments and then cluster using the background similarity. This was something I found interesting. He also suggested me some ideas for further future work. Then I also had discussion with Daryl Pfeif who is an integral member of the DFRWS Board of Directors. She complimented my research work and highlighted the importance of this work. She explained how in many crimes, the criminals cannot get arrested as the surveillance footage cannot be recovered and encouraged me to do more research in this field and maybe in the future make a tool which can perform recovery for all kind of NVRs regardless of the company.

After having some wonderful discussion, for the remaining of the day, I listened to the other paper presentations and visited the poster session. The posters gave a good overview of new and ongoing research, and I was able to talk directly with the authors about their work. The conference then ended with the closing session.

3. Travel





Outside of the conference schedule, I spent some time looking around Singapore. Seeing a new city and its culture was a pleasant break from the busy conference program. The first place I visited was Merlion Park which has a water fountain made with lion and we can see the view of the Marina Bay. Likewise, I was also able to experience the Garden Rhapsody Light Show at the Supertree Groove. Then I also went to watch Spectra – A Light & Water Show which was happening nearby.

During the first days, I was focused on preparing for my presentation, so I could not fully relax. After the presentation was finished, I felt much more comfortable and was able to enjoy the rest of my stay while thinking about what I had learned at the conference.

4. Conclusion

Attending DFRWS APAC 2026 was a very meaningful experience, because I was able to present my own research at an international conference. Through many experiments, analysis, writing, and revisions, the research finally reached the stage of being presented to other experts, and this gave me a strong sense of achievement.

Through this experience, I was able to network with professionals in this field. In addition, the workshops on agentic AI, GPS data, and ontology-based data normalization gave me practical knowledge and new ideas for future research. Listening to other presentations, joining the CTF, and talking with researchers showed me how wide and active the field of digital forensics is. I would like to use what I gained from this conference in my future research and new challenges.